

we know of Apple software these days, Cheetah was slow and lacked a lot of features. Critics opined that it was an OS that was not near ready for release. Being a complete platform up from Mac OS 9, and not just another upgrade, the release also meant that OS X had little or no compatible applications available to early adopters—another rather large bee in the average computer user's bonnet. However, Apple is notorious for having fans that vociferously defend its every move, and the early release of OS X was widely applauded by fans. As you will read later, Cheetah was soon followed by Puma (v10.1) in September 2001.

March 31: Quantum—Maxtor—Seagate

Quantum, once one of the biggest hard drive manufacturers, announced that it would be selling its hard drive business to Maxtor. At this point in time, there was a raging battle in the hard drive segment, with companies trying to outdo each other on prices. This cut-throat nature of the competition prompted Quantum stock holders to vote positively towards the decision to get out of the end-user hard drive segment and focus on tape and other media still popular with the corporate. Interestingly, not much later (in 2005), Maxtor itself was bought over by Seagate, and the price battle in this segment continues even today—which is a great thing for we the end-users.

April 11: Clippit—get off my document!

Microsoft announced that future versions of MS Office would no longer include Clippit—the animated paperclip that used to pop up when you were writing something in Word and said, “It looks like you’re writing a letter. Would you like help?” Microsoft even made ad cartoons, making fun of Clippit and announcing that Office XP onwards it was curtains for Clippit. Of course, Clippit was present in Office XP, and was just disabled by default, so the seven fans of Clippy in the world could turn that feature back on again if they desired. In Office 2003, Clippit wasn’t installed by default, but if you had the MS Office 2003 CD, you could choose to install him. It’s only with Office 2007 that Clippit was actually removed, and that there was no way to install him. Watch the car-